

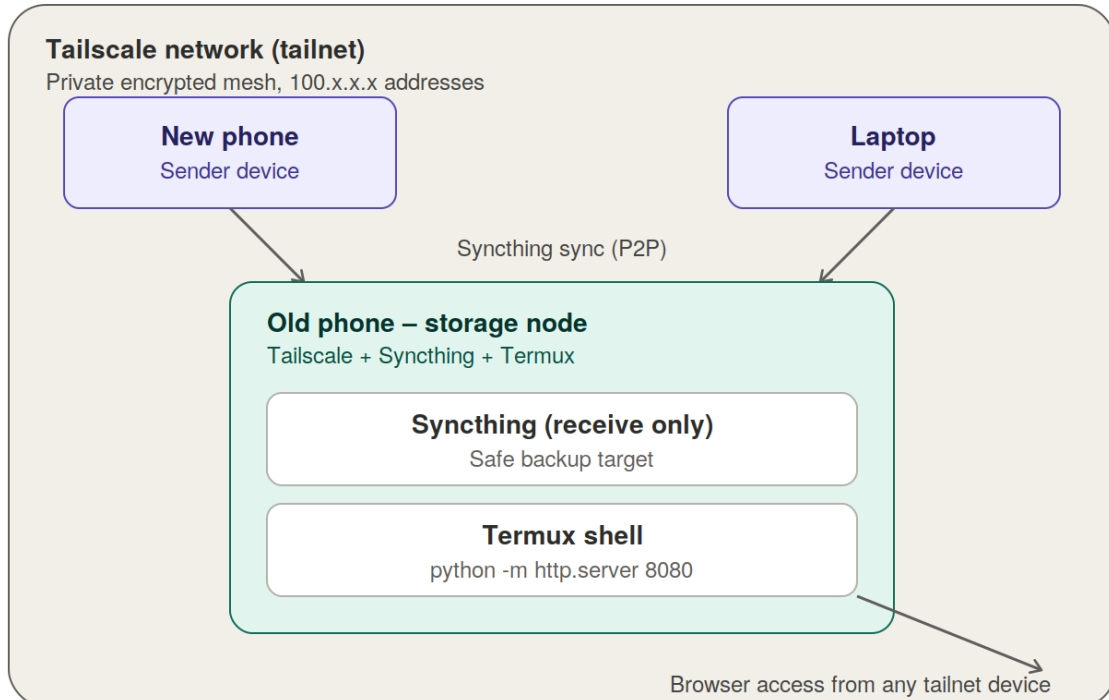
Old Phone Storage Node

Setup guide — Tailscale + Syncthing + Termux

Overview

Instead of letting an old phone gather dust, this setup repurposes it as a dedicated storage device on your personal network.

- **New phone** and **laptop** act as sending devices.
- **Old phone** acts as the storage/backup node.
- **Tailscale** connects all devices into one private, encrypted network (a "tailnet") — accessible from anywhere, no public IP or router config needed.
- **Syncthing** handles the actual file transfer/sync between devices, peer-to-peer, with no cloud middleman.
- **Termux** provides a local Linux shell on the old phone, and can optionally run a lightweight Python HTTP server for quick browser-based access to synced files.



Architecture: sender devices sync over the tailnet to the old phone's receive-only Syncthing folder

Requirements

Device	Apps needed
Old phone (storage)	Termux (F-Droid), Tailscale, Syncthing
New phone (sender)	Tailscale, Syncthing
Laptop (sender)	Tailscale, Syncthing

Setup

1 Connect all devices with Tailscale

Install Tailscale on all three devices and log in with the same account. Each device gets a stable private IP (100.x.x.x) and can reach the others directly, regardless of network or location.

2 Prepare the old phone

Inside Termux:

```
pkg update && pkg upgrade
pkg install python openssh
termux-setup-storage # grants access to shared Android storage
```

Disable battery optimization for Termux, Tailscale, and Syncthing so they keep running in the background.

3 Set up Syncthing

- Install Syncthing on all three devices.
- On each device, copy its Device ID and add it as a peer on the others.
- Share a folder from the new phone/laptop → set the old phone's folder type to **Receive Only** so it acts as a safe backup target (accidental deletions elsewhere won't wipe the phone's copy).
- Syncthing auto-discovers peers over the Tailscale network — no manual IP/port setup required.

4 Serve files over HTTP

If you want plain-browser access to files on the old phone (without opening Syncthing's UI):

```
cd /storage/emulated/0/SyncedFolder  
python -m http.server 8080
```

Then, from any device on the tailnet: `http://<old-phone-tailscale-ip>:8080`

5 Keep it running

- Use `termux-wake-lock` before starting long-running processes to prevent Android from killing them.
- Use Termux:Boot to auto-start services on phone reboot.
- Keep the phone charging if it's acting as an always-on node.